

WEEK 4 • TNF FILM AUDIT

STEELERS @ BROWNS: THE 2 PREGAME ADJUSTMENTS

A schematic breakdown of the trench battles behind Thursday night in Cleveland.

ADJUSTMENT 01 • THE GROUND GAME

5.7 YPC

WARREN'S YARDS PER CARRY

Cleveland allows 4.5 yards a carry. Warren has 216 yards on 38 carries this season.

PIT RUSH YARDS: 58 → 91 → 138

ADJUSTMENT 02 • PRESSURE POINTS

9 & 8

SACKS ALLOWED: CLE & PIT

Both offenses have leaked sacks through three games: Cleveland 9, Pittsburgh 8.

PIT EDGES: WATT 3.5 + HIGHSMITH 3.0 SACKS

THE TACTICAL IMPERATIVE

Whoever wins the line of scrimmage wins Thursday night.

Pittsburgh's run game meets a Cleveland front allowing 4.5 a carry, and both quarterbacks have been sacked often. The trenches set the script.

7-PAGE SLIDE DECK

THE GROUND GAME EDGE

THE GROUND GAME EDGE: WARREN VS. CLE'S FRONT

Pittsburgh's rushing output has climbed every week while Cleveland gives up 4.5 yards a carry.

YARDS PER CARRY: PITTSBURGH RUSHER VS. CLEVELAND DEFENSE ALLOWED

JAYLEN WARREN, 2026 SEASON



38 CARRIES, 216 YARDS • PRO-FOOTBALL-REFERENCE

BROWNS RUSH DEFENSE, YARDS ALLOWED PER CARRY



80 CARRIES, 361 YARDS ALLOWED • NFL.COM

WHAT THE NUMBERS SAY

Pittsburgh's rush yards: 58, then 91, then 138

THE TREND

Pittsburgh's rushing output rose each week, and Warren played 90% of snaps in Week 3.

RB Rico Dowdle (toe) was listed DNP on Monday's estimated report.

THE COUNTERPOINT

Cleveland has not allowed a rushing touchdown this season.

Pittsburgh has no rushing TDs either and is 2-for-6 in the red zone.

WATCH: PITTSBURGH NEEDS 4.5+ YARDS PER CARRY TO BEAT CLEVELAND'S ALLOWED RATE

THE OFFENSIVE MANDATE:

Feed Warren early and stay ahead of the chains. Pittsburgh converts just 32.4% of third downs, 29th in the NFL. Run success keeps Rodgers out of third-and-long against a Cleveland front led by Mason Graham's 4 sacks.

THE TACTICAL BLUEPRINT

THE BLUEPRINT: RUN TO SET UP THE PASS

How Pittsburgh turns a ground-game edge into a manageable script.

STEP 1 • FRONT-LOAD THE RUN

Warren gets the early-down carries

Warren ran 17 times for 127 yards against Cincinnati in Week 3. That workload is the baseline.

STEP 2 • PROTECT RODGERS

Run-first calls avoid obvious pass downs

Rodgers has been sacked 8 times for 77 yards in three games. Fewer third-and-longs mean fewer clean rush chances.

STEP 3 • WIN THIRD DOWN

Manageable distances keep Rodgers upright

Pittsburgh converts 32.4% of third downs, 29th in the NFL. Shorter distances are the lever.

THE NUMBERS BEHIND THE PLAN

127

WARREN RUSH YDS

On 17 carries vs. Cincinnati

32.4%

PIT THIRD-DOWN RATE

29th in the NFL after Week 3

8

RODGERS SACKS TAKEN

77 yards lost in 3 games

LIVE IN-GAME TRIGGER: TRACK PITTSBURGH'S FIRST-DOWN CALLS, RUN OR PASS?

THE PROTECTION PROBLEM

PRESSURE POINTS: BOTH LINES ARE LEAKING

The two offenses have allowed 17 sacks through three games.

SACKS ALLOWED THROUGH WEEK 3

CLEVELAND OFFENSE



9 SACKS TAKEN, 52 YDS LOST • WATSON • CLEVELANDBROWNS.COM

PITTSBURGH OFFENSE



8 SACKS TAKEN, 77 YDS LOST • 6.61% RODGERS SACK RATE • PFR

THE PRESSURE STORY

Each defense has a proven finisher

CLEVELAND'S PASS RUSH

Cleveland's Mason Graham leads the team with 4 sacks.

Watson has been sacked 9 times on 82 pass attempts.

PITTSBURGH'S PASS RUSH

Watt has 3.5 sacks and Highsmith 3.0: 6.5 between two edges.

Watt also has a 35-yard pick-six this season.

WATCH: SACKS ALLOWED BY QUARTER. THE BENCHMARK IS FEWER THAN 3 PER TEAM

THE DEFENSIVE MANDATE:

Speed the quarterback up. Rodgers has been sacked 8 times, Watson 9.

Quick throws and early-down runs keep drives off the third-and-long treadmill.

THE PASS-RUSH BLUEPRINT

THE BLUEPRINT: WIN THE PASS-RUSH WAR

Three things to watch as both lines try to speed up the quarterback.

STEP 1 • CHECK THE OFFICIAL INACTIVES

Cleveland's interior line is the swing factor

C Elgton Jenkins and G Teven Jenkins were listed DNP on Monday's estimated report. The official reports decide this matchup.

STEP 2 • SPEED UP THE QUARTERBACK

Quick throws blunt the rush

Watson has been sacked 9 times for 52 yards, and Rodgers 8 for 77. Shorter drops shrink the edge rushers' window.

STEP 3 • CONTAIN THE SCRAMBLE

Watson extends drives with his legs

Watson has 24 carries for 105 yards (4.4 a carry), second on the team to Judkins' 124.

THE NUMBERS BEHIND THE PLAN

9

WATSON SACKS TAKEN

52 yards lost in 3 games

6.5

WATT + HIGHSMITH SACKS

3.5 and 3.0 through Week 3

105

WATSON RUSH YDS

On 24 carries, 4.4 per carry

LIVE IN-GAME TRIGGER: TRACK SACKS AND PRESSURES QUARTER BY QUARTER

THE VALIDATION SCORECARD

HOW TO SCORE THIS REPORT LIVE ON TNF

Track these 3 benchmarks during the broadcast to see who is winning the trenches.

METRIC 01 • PROTECTION

Sacks allowed by each offense

Benchmark: fewer than 3 per team. Season average: PIT 2.7, CLE 3.0 per game.

IF IT HOLDS: THE OFFENSIVE LINE IS WINNING

METRIC 02 • THE GROUND GAME

Yards per carry vs. season allowed rate

Benchmarks: PIT 4.5 or better (CLE allows 4.5); CLE 4.4 or better (PIT allows 4.4).

IF IT HOLDS: THE RUN GAME BEATS THE FRONT

METRIC 03 • THIRD DOWN

Third-down conversions

Benchmark: 4-for-12 (33%) or better. Season rates: PIT 32.4%, CLE 30.6%.

IF IT HOLDS: DRIVES ARE STAYING ALIVE

SAVE THIS CAROUSEL FOR KICKOFF

Track these 3 benchmarks during the Prime Video broadcast.

We will post our halftime read on X and LinkedIn.



AI-POWERED SPORTS INTELLIGENCE

REAL SCHEME. REAL DATA. ZERO HOT TAKES.

We replace narrative noise with schematic charting and film verification.

PILLAR 01

LIVE TACTICAL CHARTING

Real-time tracking of box counts, coverage shells, and pressure rates.

PILLAR 02

SECOND-HALF ADJUSTMENTS

Coordinator adjustments modeled during the halftime window.

PILLAR 03

ACCOUNTABLE FILM AUDITS

Every pregame projection is checked against the game film afterward.

JOIN THE DISCUSSION

Who wins the trench war on Thursday night: Pittsburgh or Cleveland?

Drop your score prediction and tell us which adjustment decides the game.

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